TOCHI KAREN KALU

San Antonio, Texas | 737 - 334 - 7375 | 6Tochi.kalu@gmail.com | https://www.tochikalu.com/

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at San Antonio *December 2028*
*Bachelor of Science, Major: Computer Science (Honors), GPA: **3.8/4.0***
Relevant Coursework: Calculus I & II, Data Structures and Algorithms, Object- Oriented Programming, Discrete Mathematics, Software Engineering, Cloud Technologies, AI/ML Concepts
Achievements/Certificates: Dean's List, MaryRose Foundation Scholar

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, HTML/CSS, C, SQL, Typescript
Tools & Technologies: Git, GitHub, React, Next.js, OpenAI API, Tailwind CSS, REST APIs, Command Line, JSON, Linux/Unix (Command Line), HTTP Protocols, VS Code
Concepts: Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented Design, Time & Space Complexity Analysis, Client-Server Architecture

EXPERIENCE

RowdyHacks, *Logistics Organizer,* UTSA Hackathon *April 2026 – Present*
- Collaborating with organizing team to plan and execute a multi-day hackathon for **300+** participants
- Coordinating logistics including registration, scheduling, and participant support.

National Society of Black Engineers, *Membership Chair*, UTSA *May 2026 - Present*
- Facilitating productive mentor-mentee relations between **100+** UTSA alumni and current students.
- Maintaining alumni activity with monthly newsletters and **5+** events per semester, while increasing engagement from previous years by **200%.**
- Coordinate with the **16** other executive board members for the tasks in weekly meetings.

Software Development Instructor *June 2025 - July 2025*
Code2College, Austin, Tx
- Designed and delivered structured programming curriculum covering Python fundamentals, data structures, and algorithmic problem-solving.
- **25+** students mentored in debugging complex logic errors and implementing modular, maintainable code.
- Reviewed student code and provided feedback on efficiency, readability, and software design principles.

PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio Website | *Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS* *August 2026 - Present*
- Engineered and deployed a responsive personal portfolio using Next.js, React, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, with **reusable components** and **responsive layouts** across desktop and mobile devices.
- Built reusable UI components and interactive project sections to present technical work across AI, hardware, healthcare technology, and full-stack development.

TochiBot | *Python, OpenAI API, REST APIs, JSON, OOP* *September 2025 - Present*
- Engineered a context-aware AI assistant in Python, integrating **4+ external REST APIs** to support LLM-powered conversation, real-time weather, web search, and task automation.
- Architected a **modular backend** using object-oriented programming and separation of concerns, with JSON response validation and **error handling** for network failures, malformed data, and API errors.
- Developed **persistent conversational memory** and **user-state management** to retain relevant context across multi-turn interactions and provide personalized responses.
- Built an **extensible action system** supporting tasks, reminders, mood check-ins, and user-approved medication, appointment, and refill reminders.

StudyBuddy | *Arduino, C++, Ultrasonic Sensors, LCD* *October 2025*
- Developed an Arduino-based study device using **C++, ultrasonic sensors, and an LCD** to monitor sitting distance, deliver real-time posture alerts and provide customizable **20–50minute focus and break timers** to promote focused study habits.

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

First Year Experience Peer Mentor | *University of Texas at San Antonio* *August 2026 – Present*
- Mentor and support first-year students as they transition to university life by providing guidance on academic resources, campus involvement, and student success strategies.
- Facilitate discussions and activities that promote student engagement, belonging, academic confidence, and personal development.

Member: ColorStack | Society of Women Engineers (SWE) | Association of Computing Machinery (ACM) | HerScript | Code2College Alumni | INROADS | Girls Who Code